

Citability — User Guide

How to Create Consistent Character Image Stories with AI

What Is Citability?

Citability is an AI-powered image generation tool that helps you create **consistent character-based image stories**. You upload reference images of a character, write scene descriptions (prompts), and the AI generates images that maintain your character's look across every scene.

Perfect for: article illustrations, storyboards, social media content, creative projects.

Getting Started — The 3-Tab Workflow

Citability uses three tabs that follow a natural creative workflow:

① CREATE → ② GENERATE → ③ HISTORY

Tab 1: CREATE — Set Up Your Characters

This is where you define **character sets** — collections of reference images that tell the AI what your character looks like.

What You'll See

- A grid of existing character sets (cards showing name, description, and reference images)
- A "+ New Set" button in the top-right corner

Pre-Loaded Character Sets

The app comes with 4 ready-to-use character sets:

Character Set	Description	Best For
Fantasy Hero	A brave warrior from a medieval fantasy world	Fantasy stories, RPG content
Sci-Fi Explorer	A futuristic space explorer discovering new worlds	Sci-fi articles, space themes
Modern Detective	A sharp-minded investigator solving mysteries	Mystery/noir stories, thrillers
Investigative Reporter	Professional journalist uncovering truth	News articles, journalism content

Each set has **3 reference images** and **5 sample prompts** ready to go.

How to Create a New Character Set

1. Click **" + New Set "**
2. Enter a **Name** (e.g., "Cyberpunk Hacker")
3. Enter a **Description** (e.g., "A tech-savvy hacker in a neon-lit city")
4. Upload **3 reference images** of your character (different angles/poses work best)
5. Click **Save**

Tip: The more diverse your 3 reference images are (face close-up, full body, action pose), the better the AI understands your character's appearance.

How to Delete a Character Set

- Click the **trash icon** () on any character set card
- This permanently deletes the set and all its reference images

Tab 2: GENERATE — Create Your Images

This is the main workspace where you generate AI images.

Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Select a Character Set

- You'll see a grid of all your character sets on the left
- **Click on one** to select it (it gets a purple highlight border)
- When you select a set, **5 sample prompts automatically fill in** the prompt box

Step 2: Write Your Prompts

- The **Batch Prompts** section shows a text area
- **Each line = one image** that will be generated
- You can:
 - Use the auto-populated sample prompts as-is
 - Edit them to customize

- Delete them and write your own
- Add more lines for more images
- The badge in the top-right shows how many prompts you have (e.g., “5 prompts”)

Prompt Writing Tips:

- Be descriptive: “Detective examining evidence under a warm desk lamp at night” > “Detective at desk”
- Include mood/lighting: “dramatic shadows”, “golden hour”, “neon-lit”
- Describe the setting: “in a foggy alley”, “at a press conference”, “on a rooftop”
- Mention action: “running through rain”, “interviewing a source”, “reviewing documents”

Step 3: Choose Aspect Ratio

- In the **Generation Controls** panel on the right, select your aspect ratio:

Ratio	Best For
16:9 (Landscape)	Article headers, blog banners, wide scenes
1:1 (Square)	Social media posts, profile images
9:16 (Portrait)	Mobile content, vertical stories, character portraits
4:3 (Standard)	Classic format, presentations

Step 4: Generate!

- Click the purple **“Generate X Images”** button
- A progress bar shows generation status
- Each image takes approximately **10-15 seconds**
- Images appear in a grid below as they complete

Note: Image generation uses OpenAI DALL-E 3 credits (~\$0.04 per image).

Working with Generated Images

Once images are generated, you’ll see them in a responsive grid with:

- **Preview:** Click the eye icon or the image itself to view full-size in a popup
- **Download (Individual):** Click the download icon on any image
- Files are named sequentially: `001_13Apr2026.png` , `002_13Apr2026.png` , etc.
- **Download All:** Click the **“Download All”** button to download every image at once

Tab 3: HISTORY — Browse Past Generations

Every generation session is saved automatically. The History tab lets you revisit all your past work.

What You’ll See

- Generation cards organized by date (newest first)
- Each card shows:

- **Character set name** used
- **Date** of generation
- **Aspect ratio** used
- **Number of images** generated
- Thumbnail grid of all images

Downloading from History

- **Individual image:** Hover over any image to reveal the download button (arrow icon)
- **Full generation ZIP:** Click the “**Download ZIP**” button on any generation card
- Downloads all images from that session as a ZIP file

Example Workflow: Creating Article Illustrations

Here’s a real-world example of how to use Citability:

Scenario: You need 5 illustrations for an investigative journalism article

1. **Open the app** → Click the **Generate** tab
2. **Select “Investigative Reporter”** from the character set grid
3. **Prompts auto-fill** with 5 journalism-themed scenes:
 - Reporter interviewing sources in a dimly lit parking garage
 - Reviewing classified documents at a cluttered desk late at night
 - Taking covert photos at a press conference
 - Investigating a crime scene with notepad and voice recorder
 - Working late in newsroom surrounded by computer screens and evidence boards
4. **Select 16:9 (Landscape)** — perfect for article headers
5. **Click “Generate 5 Images”**
6. **Wait ~60 seconds** for all images to generate
7. **Preview** each image, then **Download All**
8. Your files are ready: `001_13Apr2026.png` through `005_13Apr2026.png`

Next time, visit the **History** tab to re-download any of these images!

Tips & Best Practices

For Best Results

- ☒ Use **3 diverse reference images** per character set (close-up, mid-shot, full body)
- ☒ Write **detailed, specific prompts** with mood, setting, and action
- ☒ Use **16:9 for articles, 1:1 for social media, 9:16 for stories**
- ☒ Keep prompts consistent with your character’s theme

Common Questions

Q: How many images can I generate at once?

A: As many as you have prompts — each line in the prompt box becomes one image.

Q: Can I edit a character set after creating it?

A: Currently you can create and delete character sets. Editing is planned for a future update.

Q: Where are my images stored?

A: All images are securely stored in AWS S3 cloud storage. You can always re-download from the History tab.

Q: What if the download button doesn't work?

A: Downloads go through a server-side proxy. If you have issues, try refreshing the page and trying again.

Q: How much does image generation cost?

A: Each image costs approximately \$0.04 using OpenAI DALL-E 3. A batch of 5 images costs about \$0.20.

Keyboard Shortcuts & Navigation

Action	How
Switch tabs	Click Create / Generate / History
Clear all prompts	Click "Clear All" below the prompt box
Full-size preview	Click any generated image
Close preview	Click X or press Escape
